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Local Privilege Escalation via chroot option

Jun 30, 2025

An attacker can leverage sudo's `-R (--chroot)` option to run arbitrary commands as root, even if they are not listed in the sudoers file.

Sudo versions affected:

Sudo versions 1.9.14 to 1.9.17 inclusive are affected.

CVE ID:

This vulnerability has been assigned [CVE-2025-32463](#) in the [Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures](#) database.

Details:

Sudo's `-R (--chroot)` option is intended to allow the user to run a command with a user-selected root directory if the sudoers file allows it. A change was made in sudo 1.9.14 to resolve paths via `chroot()` using the user-specified root directory while the sudoers file was still being evaluated. It is possible for an attacker to trick sudo into loading an arbitrary shared library by

creating an `/etc/nsswitch.conf` file under the user-specified root directory.

The change from sudo 1.9.14 has been reverted in sudo 1.9.17p1 and the chroot feature has been marked as deprecated. It will be removed entirely in a future sudo release. Because of the way sudo resolves commands, supporting a user-specified chroot directory is error-prone and this feature does not appear to be widely used.

A more detailed description of the bug and its effects can be found in the [Stratascale advisory](#).

Impact:

On systems that support `/etc/nsswitch.conf` a user may be able to run arbitrary commands as root.

Fix:

The bug is fixed in sudo 1.9.17p1.

Credit:

Thanks to Rich Mirch from Stratascale Cyber Research Unit (CRU) for reporting and analyzing the bug. His advisory may be found at <https://www.stratascale.com/vulnerability-alert-CVE-2025-32463-sudo-chroot>.

[Local Privilege Escalation via host option](#)